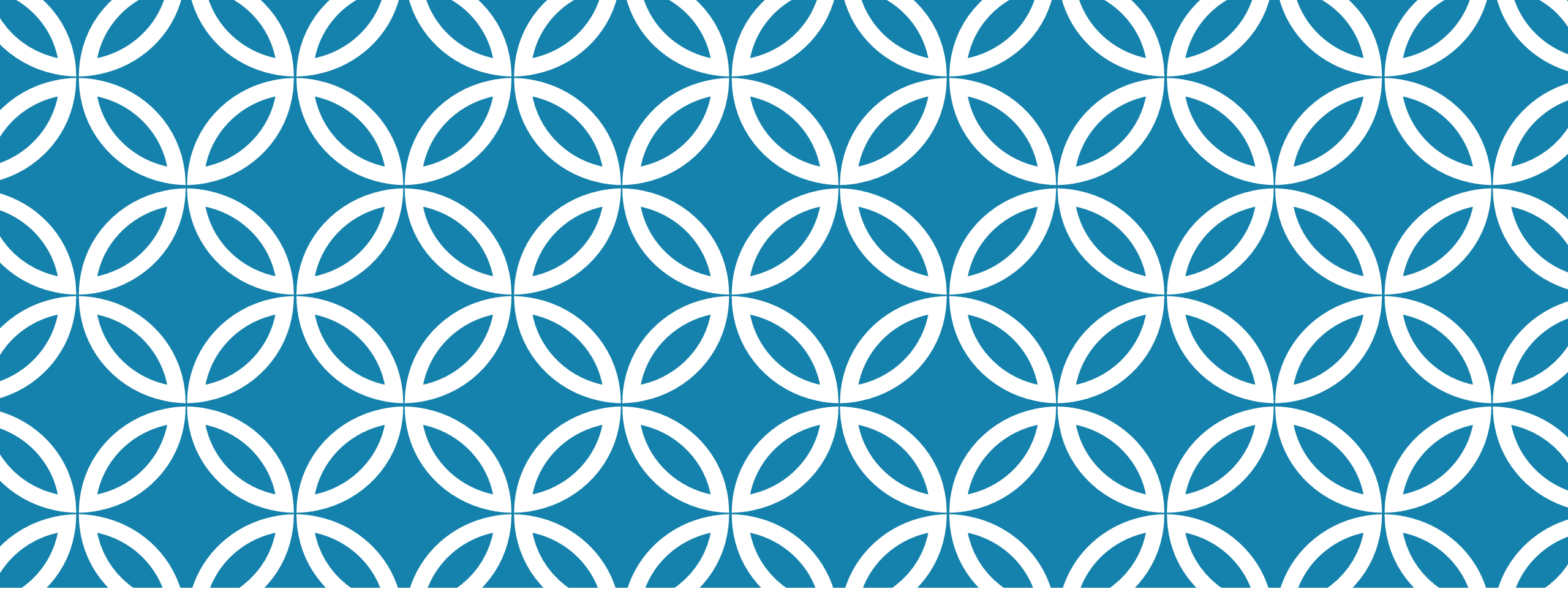
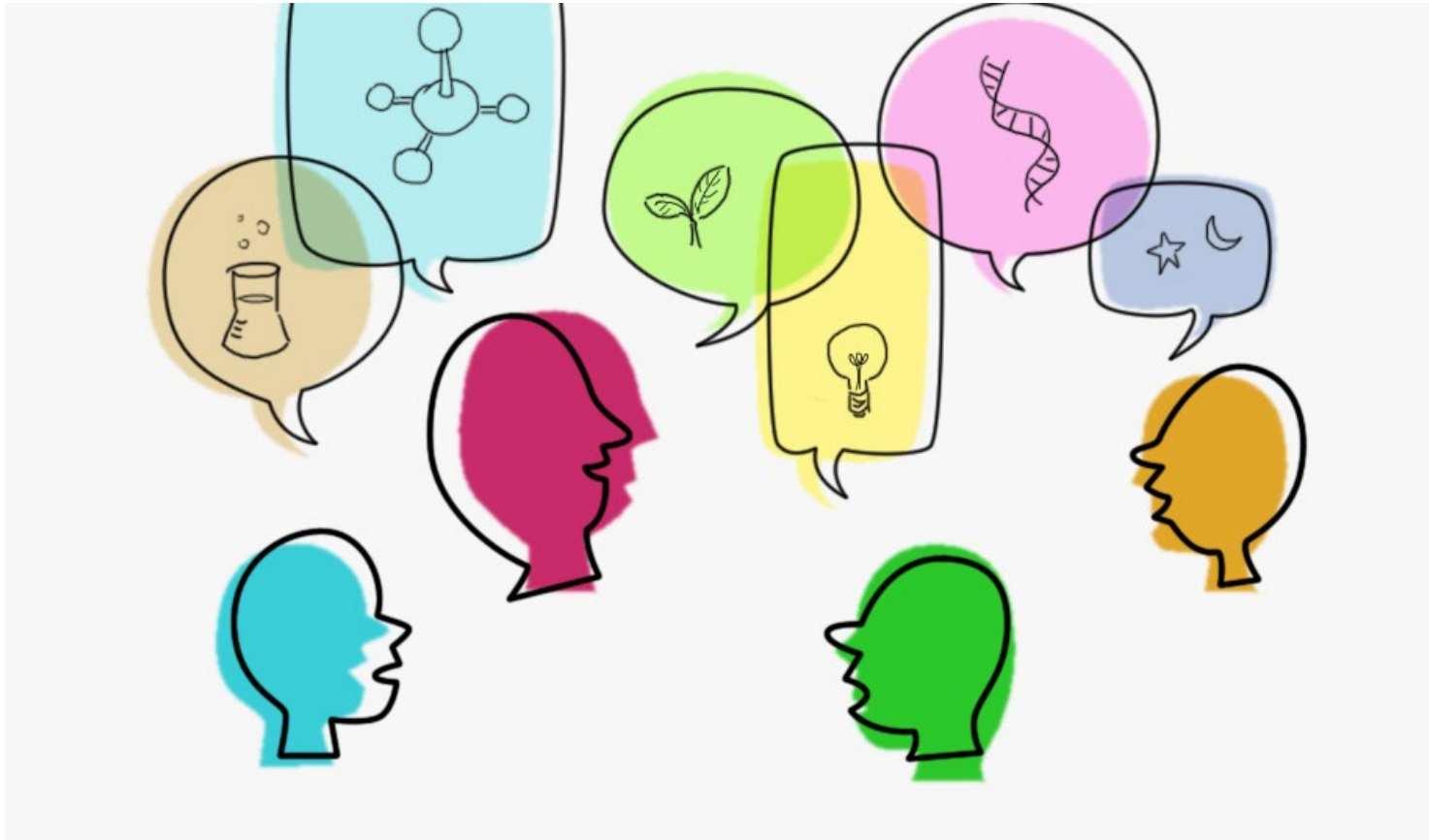




NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

Dr. Emma Sweeney
Office 3-053
Emma.Sweeney@tudublin.ie



LAST WEEK ...

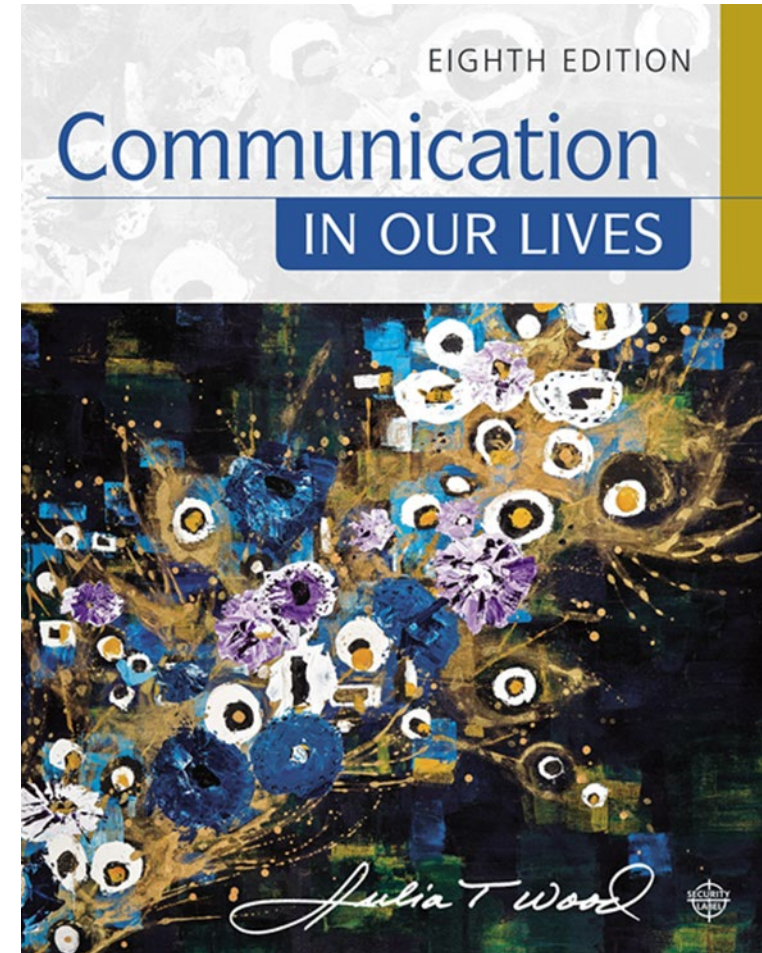
3 models of
communication:
1.Linear
2.Interactive
3.Transactional

TEXTBOOK

**Wood, J.T. (2018).
Communication in Our
Lives (8th ed.). Boston:
Cengage Learning.**

This week:

**Chapter Six – The
Nonverbal Dimension of
Communication**



Imagine your co-worker storms into her office after lunch. She's red-faced, tight-lipped and speaks to no one. She throws her briefcase on the desk, plops down in her chair and glares out the window. You ask, "Are you all right?"
She snaps back in an angry tone, "I'm fine!"

Which message do you believe: Her nonverbal communication (behaviour and voice tone), or her verbal one (words alone)?

Research shows that when a person sends a mismatched message, recipients almost always believe the predominant nonverbal message over the verbal one

Nonverbal communication has been shown to carry between 65% and 93% more impact than the actual words spoken

Possible to exchange up to 10,000 nonverbal cues in less than one minute

Can significantly impact your success in the workplace

(Smith, 2013)

NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

All aspects of communication other than words themselves

“What you do speaks so loudly that I cannot hear what you say” -
Ralph Waldo Emerson

Facial expressions can express interest, competitiveness, sorrow, anger, etc.

Body postures can convey relaxation, nervousness, boredom, power

Dress can express social standing, cultural heritage, profession (& rank within profession)

VERBAL AND NONVERBAL: SIMILAR YET DIFFERENT

Similarities

- Verbal & non-verbal are both symbolic
- Both are rule-guided
 - **Regulative rules:** when and where certain behaviours are appropriate
 - **Constitutive rules** tell us what certain behaviours are understood to count as
- Both are culture bound
- Can be both intentional or unintentional

Differences

Non-verbal perceived as more honest

Non-verbal is multi-channelled

Non-verbal is continuous

TYPES OF NONVERBAL BEHAVIOUR

1. Kinesics
2. Haptics
3. Physical Appearance
4. Artifacts
5. Proxemics
6. Environmental Factors
7. Chronemics
8. Paralanguage
9. Silence

1. KINESICS

Refers to body position and body motions, including those of the face

Our bodies communicate a great deal about how we see ourselves

We also communicate moods with body posture and motion

- E.g. Audiences show interest by alert body posture and good eye contact with speakers, and they signal disinterest by slumped posture and lack of eye contact

Body posture and gestures may signal whether we are open to interaction & are therefore integral to building relationships

We use gestures to signal how we feel about others and situations

Our faces are intricate messengers – the face is particularly powerful in conveying liking and responsiveness

Strong eye contact seen to heighten the credibility of public speakers in Western societies, while perceptions of distrust increase with the absence of eye contact (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)

1

2

3

4

5

6

7



Decoding debate body language



2. HAPTICS

Physical touch

Necessary for human social development

Research shows that touch releases oxytocin and endorphins (biological correlates of social connection) and facilitates the release of dopamine (the hormone that results in feelings of well-being) (Sekerdej et al, 2018)

- touch enhances one's interpersonal involvement, positive affect, social attachment, intimacy, and overall liking (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)

On the other hand, can also communicate (deliberately or unintentionally) hierarchy-related messages (Sekerdej et al, 2018) - can communicate power and status

Can be welcoming, threatening, or persuasive

- Hornik (1992): restaurant patrons touched by servers expressed positive regard for servers & even complied with requests from them

3. PHYSICAL APPEARANCE

Physical features of people and the values attached to those features

Sex, skin colour, size, and features

Western culture places an extremely high value on physical appearance (Wood, 2016)

“Studies suggest that physically attractive communicators are more persuasive (Chaiken, 1979), successful in changing attitudes (Kahle and Homer, 1985), and are perceived as being more friendly than less attractive communicators” (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)

- However, more important in initial encounters - impact of a communicator's physical attractiveness diminishes as the receiver obtains more information about the communicator

Cultures stipulate ideals for physical form

4. ARTIFACTS

Personal objects with which we announce our identities and personalize our environments

Ranges from clothes, jewellery and tattoos to personal objects we decorate our spaces with

Expresses personal identity

Company logos are also considered artifacts

Many organisations introduce dress codes to control impact of artifacts

Attire colour influences perception e.g., darker suits create a perception of dominance and authority while lighter suits are associated with friendliness (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)







5. PROXEMICS & PERSONAL SPACE

Proxemics refers to space and how we use it

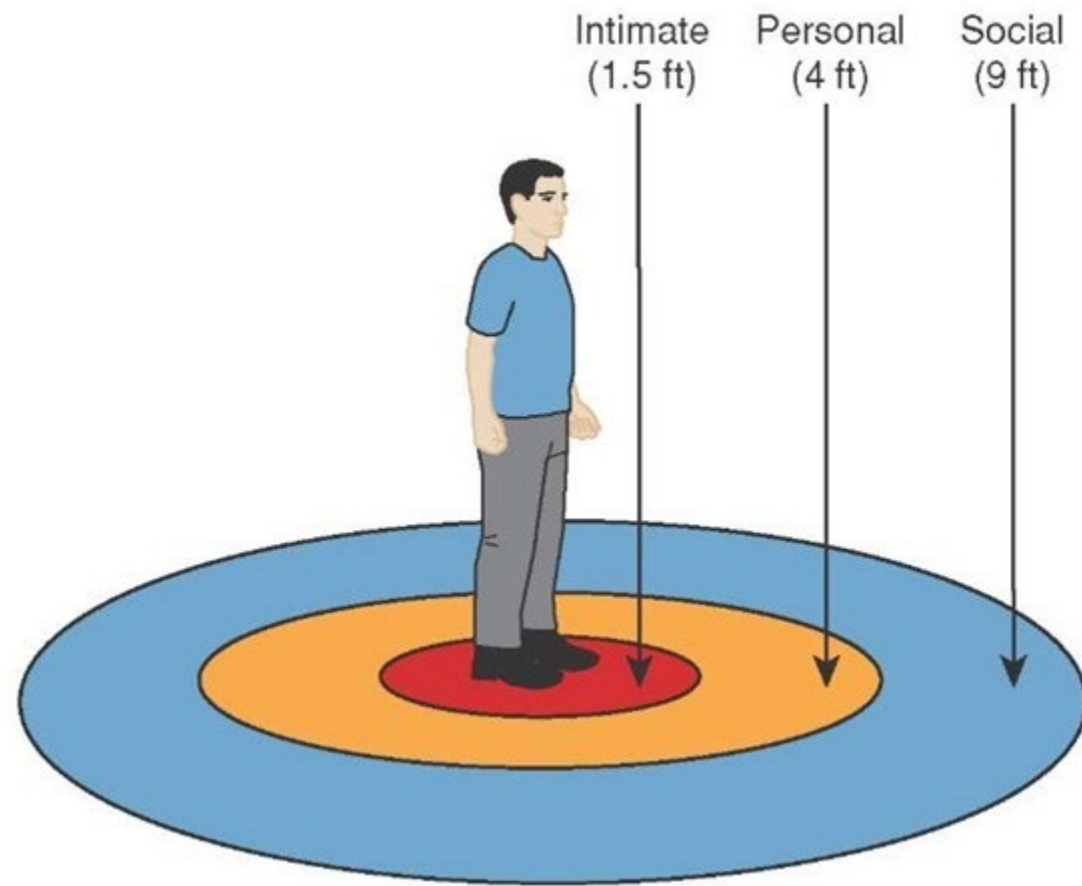
Every culture has norms for using space and how close people should be to one another (Hall, 1968)

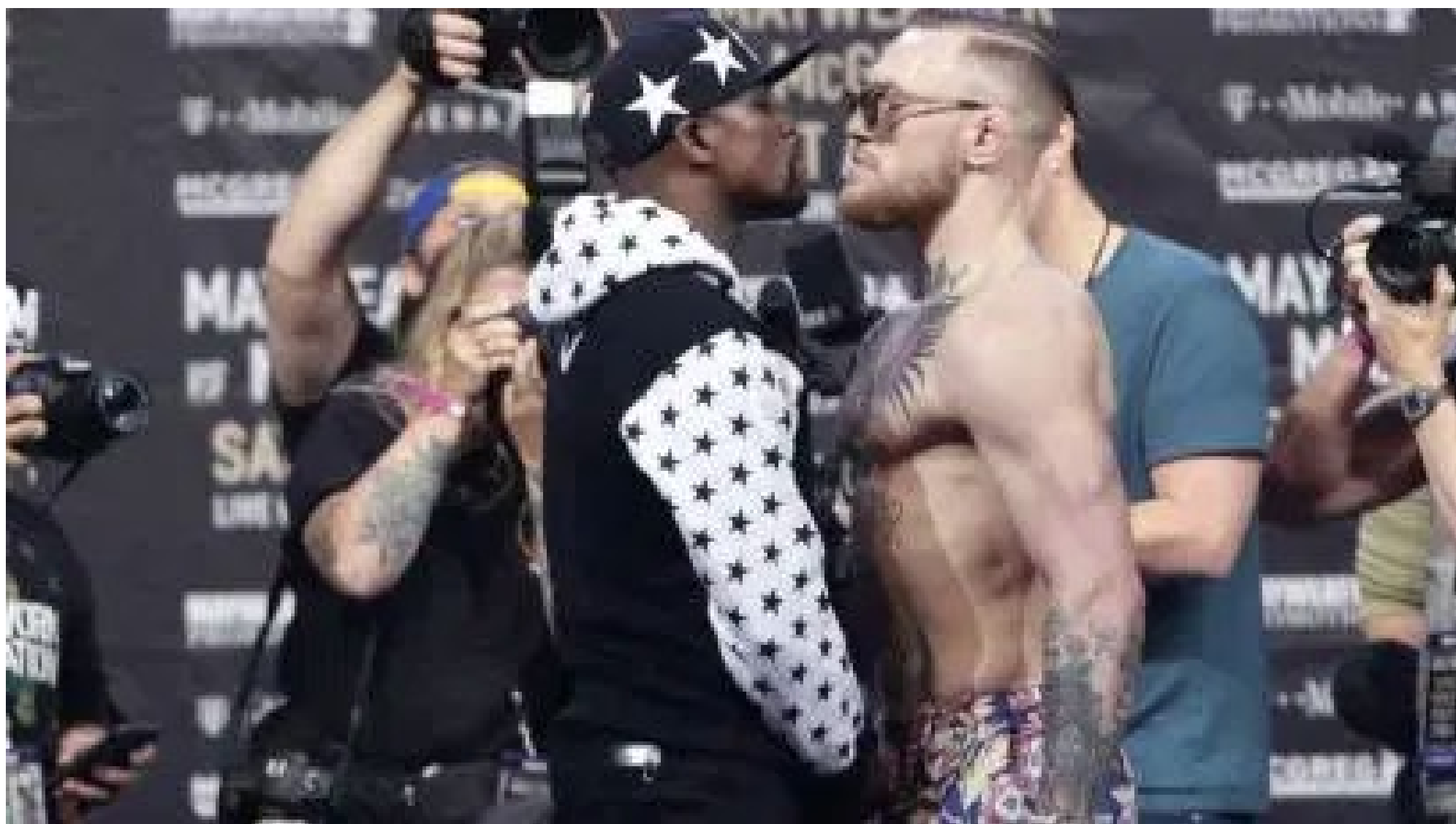
Space also announces status, with greater space and more desirable space assumed by those with higher status in a culture

The way in which offices are arranged may invite or discourage interaction and may foster equal or unequal power relationships

Territoriality - an innate drive to take up and defend spaces (Hans & Hans, 2015, p.50)







6. ENVIRONMENTAL FACTORS

Elements of a setting that affect how we think, feel and act

- Architecture, colors, room design, smells, lighting, temperature, etc.

A New Jersey hospital redesigned their rooms to increase natural daylight and otherwise create more attractive environments – patients in the redesigned rooms asked for 30% less medication and rated food better than patients in the remodeled rooms even though the food was the same (Kimmelman, 2014)

Restaurants use environmental features to control how long people spend eating

- Lighting, comfort of chairs, pace of music



7. CHRONEMICS

Refers to how we perceive and use time to define identities and interaction

We use time to negotiate and convey status

Chronemics express cultural attitudes towards time

Countries with the fastest pace of life are Switzerland, Ireland, Germany and Japan (Levine & Norenzayan, 1999)

Western culture values speed

Time spent indicates status of a relationship



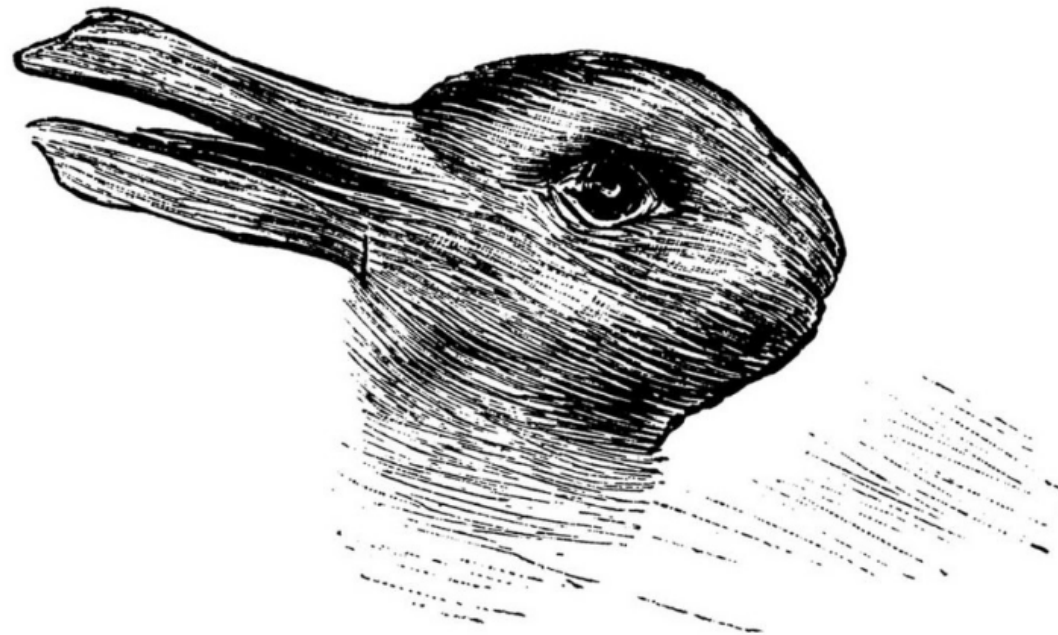
CROSS-CULTURAL MANAGEMENT

Different Cultures See Deadlines Differently

by [Bhaskar Pant](#)

May 23, 2016

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8. PARALANGUAGE

Paralanguage is communication that is vocal but not actual words

- Includes sounds, such as murmurs and gasps, and vocal qualities such as volume, rhythm, pitch and inflection

Vocal cues signal others to interpret what we say as a joke, a threat, a statement of fact, a question, etc

Effective public speakers modulate inflection, volume and rhythm to enhance their presentations - pitch variation shown to enhance perceptions of competence and sociability (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)

Tone of voice is a powerful clue to feelings

“Research reveals that when a listener or receiver attempts to judge where the speaker or source is on a contempt-affection continuum, they rely more on the tone of the voice than on the content of the message” (Sundaram & Webster, 2000, p.383)

9. SILENCE

Lack of verbal communication or paralanguage

Can express powerful messages

Can be a powerful tool when speaking publicly

- Brief to moderate pauses tend to enhance perceptions of credibility and trustworthiness (Sundaram & Webster, 2000)

IMPROVING NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

Monitor your nonverbal communication

- Are you projecting the image you desire? Do others interpret your facial and body movements in ways consistent with the image you want to project?
- Monitor your nonverbal actions to more clearly communicate your involvement and interest

Interpret others' nonverbal communication tentatively

- Because nonverbal communication is ambiguous and personal, we should not assume we can interpret it with precision

SUMMARY OF NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

What we have covered:

- Similarities & differences within nonverbal communication
- Types of nonverbal communication
- The implications for how you are communicating
- Improving nonverbal communication



NONVERBAL COMMUNICATION

1. Examine the nonverbal communication of both Leo Varadkar and Michael Martin using as many of the following as possible: Kinesics, Haptics, Physical Appearance, Artifacts, Proxemics, Chronemics, Paralanguage and Silence.
2. Who is the more effective communicator in your opinion? Why?

